Nicholas Bamshad Aoki

Curriculum Vitae as of October 13, 2026

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

cognitive science, psycholinguistics, sociolinguistics, phonetics/phonology, speech perception, human-AI interaction

EMPLOYMENT

2026- **University of California, Davis**
Postdoctoral Affiliate, Phonetics Laboratory, Department of Linguistics

EDUCATION

Degrees

2021-2026 **University of California, Davis**
Ph.D. in Linguistics
Cumulative GPA: 4.00/4.00
Dissertation: From Idiosyncrasy to Generalization: The Role of Sociolinguistic Experience on Adaptation to Novel Talkers
Committee: Georgia Zellou, Fernanda Ferreira, Santiago Barreda-Castañón

2020-2021 **University of Chicago**
M.A. in Digital Studies of Language, Culture, and History
Cumulative GPA: 4.00/4.00
Thesis: Do Hillary Clinton and Kamala Harris Imitate the Accent of their Audience at Campaign Rallies?
Advisor: Alan C. L. Yu

2017-2021 **University of Chicago**
B.A. in Linguistics, Minor in Statistics
Cumulative GPA: 3.95/4.00
College Honors: Phi Beta Kappa, Student Marshal, *summa cum laude*

Non-Degrees

2025 **University of Oregon**
Linguistic Society of America Summer Institute

2018 **University of Chicago Center in Paris,** Paris, France
Advanced French Study Abroad Program

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

2026 Georgia Zellou, Nicole Holliday, & **Nicholas B. Aoki**. Introduction to the special issue on the phonetics of human-AI interaction. Forthcoming at *Phonetica*.

2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. Apparent talker variability and speaking style similarity can enhance comprehension of novel L2-accented talkers. *Language and Speech, 69*(3), 946-976. https://doi.org/10.1177/00238309251390505

2025 Maryam Bamshad, Karina Xie, Rema Rasheed, Kathryn Holt, Grace Assabil-Bentum, & **Nicholas B. Aoki**. Exposure to subtle dominance cues in asymmetric power relationships activates the stress response and affects decision-making. *Frontiers in Psychology, 16*, 1517308. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2025.1517308

2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. When multiple talker exposure is necessary for cross-talker generalization: Insights into the emergence of sociolinguistic perception. *Glossa Psycholinguistics, 4*(1). https://doi.org/10.5070/g6011.21217

2024 Jules Vonessen, **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Michelle Cohn & Georgia Zellou. Comparing perception of L1 and L2 English by human listeners and machines: Effect of interlocutor adaptations. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America, 155*(5), 3060-3070. https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0025930

2024 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. Being *clear* about clear speech: Intelligibility of hard-of-hearing-directed, non-native-directed, and casual speech for L1- and L2-English listeners. *Journal of Phonetics, 104*, 101328. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.wocn.2024.101328

2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. Visual information affects adaptation to novel talkers: Ethnicity-specific and ethnicity-independent learning of L2-accented speech. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America, 154*(4), 2290-2304. https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0021289

2022 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Michelle Cohn, & Georgia Zellou. The clear speech intelligibility benefit for text-to-speech voices: Effects of speaking style and visual guise. *JASA Express Letters, 2*(4), 045204. https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0010274

Refereed Conference Proceedings

2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. When clear speech does not enhance memory: Effects of speaking style, voice naturalness, and listener age. *Proceedings of Meetings on Acoustics, 51*(1), 060002. https://doi.org/10.1121/2.0001766

2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. Speakers talk more clearly when they see an East Asian face: Effects of visual guise on speech production. In Radek Skarnitzl & Jan Volín (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 20th International Congress of Phonetic Sciences* (pp. 2294-2298). Guarant International. https://tinyurl.com/y6kdnvc9

Manuscripts Under Review

Nicholas B. Aoki & Georgia Zellou. Voice cloning increases intelligibility of L2-English voices: Listener benefit or speaker detriment? Under review at *International Congress of Phonetics Sciences 2027*.

Manuscripts In Preparation

Nicholas B. Aoki & Georgia Zellou. The voice cloning intelligibility detriment: Comprehension ratings decrease when listeners are told that the voices are artificially generated. To be submitted to *Scientific Reports*.

Nicholas B. Aoki & Georgia Zellou. Hey Alexa, are you glitching on me?: Investigating phonological generalization across human and device guises. To be submitted to *Laboratory Phonology*.

Nicholas B. Aoki, Santiago Barreda, & Georgia Zellou. Equivalent effects of speaking rate on intelligibility for L1- and L2-English listeners. To be submitted to *Journal of Speech, Language, and Hearing Research*.

Maryam Bamshad, **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Fairuz Abdalla, Brittany Agustin, Brenda Flores, Luisiana Guzman, Yawa Koumako, Salwa Mohammed, & Karina Xie. Probability estimates and decision making vary based on autonomic reaction to dominant versus sympathetic speaker attitude. To be submitted to *Behavioral Sciences*.

INVITED PRESENTATIONS AND GUEST LECTURES

2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki.** Effective communication in the generative AI era. *Guest lecture at Biology Journal Review [BIO 440]*. City University of New York, Lehman College.

2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki.** Phonology in use: Usage-based phonology and the usefulness of phonological theory for career development. *Guest lecture at Introduction to Phonological Theory [LIN 111]*. University of California, Davis.

2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki.** When multiple talker exposure is necessary for cross-talker generalization: Insights into the emergence of sociolinguistic perception. *Invited talk at The Berkeley Phonetics, Phonology and Psycholinguistics Forum*. University of California, Berkeley.

2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki.** From qualifying paper to journal article: Tips and tricks for successful publication. *Guest lecture at Proseminar [LIN 201]*. University of California, Davis.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

[* = Undergraduate trainee supervised by NBA]

2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Hey Alexa, are you glitching on me?: Investigating phonological adaptation and generalization across human and device guises. *The 20th Conference on Laboratory Phonology.* Montréal, Canada.

2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Hey Alexa, are you glitching on me?: Investigating phonological adaptation and generalization across human and device guises. *12th UC Davis Symposium on Language Research*. Davis, USA.

2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Hey Alexa, are you glitching on me?: Investigating phonological adaptation and generalization across human and device guises. *190th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America.* Philadelphia, USA.

2026 *Bayleigh Baldwin, **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Lacey Wade, and Georgia Zellou. Talkin' country in w[a:]ne country: Sociolinguistic variation in Napa, California. *50th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference*. Philadelphia, USA.

2026 Karina Xie, Fairuz Abdalla, Britanny Augustin, Brenda Flores, Luisiana Guzman, Yawa Koumako, Salwa Mohammed, **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Maryam Bamshad. Medical decision-making is impacted by the doctor's speech tone and framing of probability statement for the treatment success. *The New England Science Symposium*. Boston, USA.

2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Apparent talker variability and speaking style similarity can enhance comprehension of novel L2-accented talkers: Evidence for numerosity and similarity accounts of cross-talker generalization. *100th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*. New Orleans, USA.

2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Apparent talker variability and speaking style similarity can enhance comprehension of novel L2-accented talkers: Evidence for numerosity and similarity accounts of cross-talker generalization. *189th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Honolulu, USA.

2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. When multiple talker exposure is necessary for cross-talker generalization: Social co-variation facilitates the emergence of sociolinguistic perception. *99th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*. Philadelphia, USA.

2024 *****Bayleigh Baldwin, **Nicholas B. Aoki**, and Georgia Zellou. "Country Talk" in California's Napa Valley. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 52*. Miami, USA.

2024 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. When multiple talker exposure is necessary for cross-talker generalization: Social co-variation facilitates the emergence of sociolinguistic perception. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 52*. Miami, USA.

2024 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Effects of speaking style and apparent talker variability on perceptual adaptation to L2-accented speech. *10th UC Davis Symposium on Language Research*. Davis, USA.

2024 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Ethnicity-specific and -independent learning: Effects of guise on adaptation to novel foreign-accented talkers. *98th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*. New York City, USA.

2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. When speaking clearly does not enhance comprehension: Comparing intelligibility of hard-of-hearing- and non-native-directed speech for native and non-native listeners. *185th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Sydney, Australia.

2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Ethnicity-specific and -independent learning: Effects of guise on adaptation to novel foreign-accented talkers. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 51*. New York City, USA.

2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Speakers talk more clearly when they see an Asian face: Effects of visual guise on speech production. *20th International Congress of Phonetic Sciences*. Prague, Czech Republic.

2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Comparing intelligibility and recognition memory of human and text-to-speech voices. *184th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Chicago, USA.

2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Masoud Jasbi, and Georgia Zellou. Under-informative utterances can be more accepted from digital devices than humans. *97th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*. Denver, USA.

2022 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Hey Alexa, are you a Valley Girl? Effects of social information on the perception of text-to-speech voices. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 50*. San Jose, USA.

2022 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Michelle Cohn, and Georgia Zellou. The clear speech intelligibility benefit for TTS Voices: Effects of speech style and guise. *The 18th Conference on Laboratory Phonology*, Virtual.

2021 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Alan C. L. Yu. Do Hillary Clinton and Kamala Harris imitate the accent of their audiences? Analysis and interpretation of stylistic variability. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 49,* Virtual.

2021 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Henry Mackall, and Alan C. L. Yu. Does variation in speech production impact acoustic cue weighting in speech perception? *2021 University of Chicago Undergraduate Research Symposium*, Virtual.

2020 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Jacob B. Phillips, Daniel Chen, and Alan C. L. Yu. Convergence of the lot-thought merger in the U.S. Supreme Court. *94th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*, New Orleans, USA.

MEDIA APPEARANCES

2023 Kat Setzer. Student Paper Competition: Chicago [19:49-30:53]. Across Acoustics [Official Podcast of the Acoustical Society of America]. https://acrossacoustics.buzzsprout.com/1537384/14065240-student-paper-competition-chicago

AWARDS AND HONORS

2026 Bob Bayley Award, UC Davis Department of Linguistics, $1200

2026 Outstanding Graduate Student Teaching Award, UC Davis, $1000

2026 Sigma Xi, UC Davis

2025 Graduate Student Travel Award, UC Davis Department of Linguistics, $500

2025 Student Transportation Award, Acoustical Society of America, $150

2025 Linguistic Society of America (LSA) Summer Institute Fellowship, UC Davis Department of Linguistics, $5668

2025 Outstanding Graduate Student Teaching Award Nominee, UC Davis

2024 Outstanding Graduate Student Teaching Award Nominee, UC Davis

2024 Phi Kappa Phi, UC Davis

2023 Proceedings of Meetings on Acoustics Student Paper Competition Winner, Acoustical Society of America, $300

2023 "Down Under Funder" Travel Grant, Acoustical Society of America, $1,000

2023 Steven Lapointe Award, UC Davis Department of Linguistics, $850

2023 Student Award, International Phonetic Association, GBP 600

2022 Travel Award, UC Davis Graduate Student Association, $250

2022-2023 Graduate Research Mentorship Fellowship, UC Davis, $48,900

2021-2022 Provost's Fellowship in the Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences, UC Davis, $59,802

2021 Latin Honors (summa cum laude), Univ. of Chicago

2021 Leonard Bloomfield Prize in Linguistics, Univ. of Chicago

2020 Phi Beta Kappa (Early Induction), Univ. of Chicago

2020 Student Marshal, Univ. of Chicago

2020 College Summer Research Fellow, Univ. of Chicago, $5,000

2019-2020 College Research in the Arts, Social Sciences, and Humanities Scholar, Univ. of Chicago $5,000

2019 Jeff Metcalf Internship, Univ. of Chicago

2019 Dean's Fund for Undergraduate Research Award, Univ. of Chicago, $1,271

2019 Liew Family College Research Fellow, Univ. of Chicago, $1,000

2017-2021 Dean's List, Univ. of Chicago

2017-2021 National Merit Scholarship, $8,000

TEACHING

LIN 171 – Introduction to Psycholinguistics (Winter '24, Spring '25)

LIN 111 – Introduction to Phonological Theory (Spring '26)

LIN 103A – Linguistic Analysis I: Phonetics, Phonology, Morphology (Fall '24, Winter '26)

LIN 001/001Y – Introduction to Linguistics (Fall '23, Spring '24, Summer Session I '24, Summer Session II '24, Winter '25, Spring '25, Fall '25)

UNDERGRADUATE ADVISING

Honors Theses

2024-2025 Bayleigh Baldwin, "The social meaning of 'Country Talk' in California's Napa Valley", UC Davis [co-mentor with Georgia Zellou]

Research Assistants

2025 Hyunjin (Dylan) Lim, UC Davis

2023 Lilly Vanhoy, UC Davis

SERVICE

Editor

2025-2026 Phonetica, Special Issue on Phonetics of Human-AI interaction, Co-guest editor (along with Georgia Zellou and Nicole Holliday)

Ad-hoc Journal Reviewing

2026 American Journal of Audiology, Ampersand, Linguistics Vanguard, JASA Express Letters

2025 Journal of Phonetics, Speech Communication [n = 2]

2024 Journal of the Acoustical Society of America

2022 Journal of the Acoustical Society of America [co-review w/ Georgia Zellou]

Conference Abstract Reviewing

2025-2026 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics

2022-2026 UC Davis Cluster on Language Research Symposium

Organized Sessions and Symposia

2023 UC Davis Cluster on Language Research Symposium (co-organized with Roxanne Elliott and Ana Ortega Pérez)

Other Service

2026 Panelist, UC Davis Undergraduate Linguistics Club [Q+A Session About Graduate School Applications]

2025 Member, California Meeting on Psycholinguistics Planning Committee

2024-2026 Website Manager, UC Davis Phonetics Lab

2023-2024 Website Manager, UC Davis Linguistics Department [Creator of Position]

2023-2024 Representative, UC Davis Graduate Student Association

2022-2023 Volunteer Tutor, Sacramento Public Library Adult Literacy Program

2022-2026 Member, UC Davis Cluster on Language Research Committee

2021-2022 Member, UC Davis Graduate and Professional School Events Review Board

2020-2021 Member, Univ. of Chicago Senior Class Gift Committee

2017-2021 Founder, Univ. of Chicago Phoenix Tutoring (President, Coordinator, Tutor)

LANGUAGES

English (L1 or "native"), French (advanced), Spanish (advanced), Japanese (intermediate), Farsi (beginning)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Coding: R, R Markdown, LaTeX, Python, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Acoustic-Phonetic Analysis: Praat, FastTrack, Forced Alignment (FAVE, WebMAUS, Montreal Forced Aligner), ELAN

Experiment Development: Qualtrics, Gorilla, Prolific, E-Prime

Miscellaneous: eye-tracking, EEG, iMotions

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

2026- Sigma Xi

2024- Phi Kappa Phi

2023- Acoustical Society of America

2023- International Phonetic Association

2022- Association for Laboratory Phonology

2020- Linguistic Society of America

2020- Phi Beta Kappa

REFERENCES

Dr. Georgia Zellou
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Dr. Laurel Lawyer
Associate Professor of Linguistics
University of California, Davis
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Associate Professor of Linguistics
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nicole.holliday@berkeley.edu

Dr. Emily Morgan
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eimorgan@ucdavis.edu

Dr. Fernanda Ferreira
Professor of Psychology
University of California, Davis
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Dr. Alan C. L. Yu
Professor of Linguistics
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